Grow Your Garden

M-109-167

Young Lions 2025

WhyHunger



What do we know about Gen Z & Millennials?

Gen Z



Digital natives that prefer visual content such as videos and images over long text.



Gen Z tend to lean on their moral compass with a strong inclination to stand up for what's right.



Concerned with social and environmental issues. They are more likely to support brands with social and environmental responsibility.

Millennials



67% feel they can make a difference for a cause they care about.



Millennials aren't as susceptible to marketing tactics as other audiences.



They're **quietly optimistic** about the environment.

Sources: Dentsu, the Shelf, Missouri State, GWI, Forty8Creates

Challenge

"I'll get to it later."

"This is out of my budget."

"I care, but where is my money going?"

Gen Z and Millennials' care about sustainable food practices and fighting food insecurity but don't know how to get involved

63%

Of Gen Z turn to social media for information and news.

80%

Of millennials are keen to learn more about how their food is produced and to get a glimpse behind the scenes of the production or manufacturing process.

Gen Z are early adopters when it comes to sustainable behaviors.

50% reduced how much they buy and 45% stopped purchasing certain brands because of sustainability or ethics concerns.

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Sources: Forbes, iGrow News, Morning Consult, Virtual College

Insight

Gen Z and Millennials support climate-smart agricultural practices but struggle to fight against the spread of misinformation

48% of Millennials and

52%

of Gen Z are **concerned about food insecurity** amongst economic issues.

68%

said they feel they would benefit from more information from retailers about the sustainability of various food product.

Over

60%

of Gen Z feels more strongly about food sourcing and ingredient transparency than they did five years ago.

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Sources: United Way, Food Business News, The Packer

Big Idea

Grow Your Garden

WhyHunger partners with Whole Foods Market to empower Gen Z and millennials to learn sustainable gardening practices. Through live gardening classes, sustainable food kits, and the opportunity to kickstart your very own backyard gardens, participants will also engage in local community outreach challenges. These challenges encourage them to donate a portion of their harvest to WhyHunger's partner soup kitchens and food drives, fostering a culture of growth, sustainability, and social impact. At the end of the, there will be a pop up celebrating the 40th Hungerthon and 50th WhyHunger anniversary in the city that drives the most engagement.

Grow Together, Feed Together

Nationwide Whole Foods Market will offer in person and live streamed knowledge sessions sharing techniques with local experts on how to grow a garden in your own home each week for six weeks. This partnership with Whole Foods offers in store sustainable food kits with eco-friendly tools, seeds, and guides after each participant registers to be a part of the 2025 Hungerthon. Each registered user will receive a unique Hungerthon login.

Planting Seeds of Change

Participants are encouraged to share their gardening progress on social media using #GrowYourGarden, while gaining insights into the amount of food donated and how their efforts contribute to alleviating food insecurity by using their login code on the WhyHunger website. This fosters transparency and highlights the direct impact of their involvement. Any monetization from the #GrowYourGarden will be donated to this year's Hungerthon.

Rooted in Community

At the end of the six week #GrowYourGarden campaign, the city with the most engagement and traction will earn the chance to be part of WhyHunger's 50th anniversary and 40th Hungerthon pop up celebration. This milestone event will spotlight WhyHunger's mission to address food insecurity, promote social justice, and champion agroecology practices. Featuring new corporate Partner Too Good To Go and content influencers involved in a six week lead up.

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Why We Love It

Whole Foods redefines quality through responsible sourcing

WhyHunger x Whole Foods Market is rooted in a shared mission to cultivate a sustainable future through community-driven action, while supporting the values of environmental stewardship, quality, and food security. This collaboration aims to engage Gen Z and Millennials in hands-on learning experiences that both empower individuals and create lasting, positive social impact.

WHOLE FOODS MARKET x why. WhyHunger

“Prioritizing a positive climate impact while continuing to meet us rigorous quality standards is part of our identity at Whole Foods Market”

--Whole Foods CEO, Jason Buechel

Shared commitment to sustainability

Both organizations share a strong commitment to sustainability with Whole Foods consistently upholding rigorous quality standards while actively contributing to the health of the planet. This partnership builds on Whole Foods ongoing efforts to reduce food waste, support regenerative agriculture, and promote a more resilient food system.

Creating Impactful Learning Opportunities

Through live gardening workshops and sustainable food kits, participants not only learn the skills to grow their own food but also connect to a larger movement of mindful eating and environmental responsibility. Whole Foods' high-quality products and sustainable practices reinforce the educational content, giving participants a tangible connection to the principles of sustainable living.

Bridging The Gap

WhyHunger’s goal to reshape food systems by empowering communities perfectly aligns with Whole Foods’ commitment to making a positive impact. Together, they connect food access with sustainability by encouraging participants to share part of their harvest with local soup kitchens and food banks. In doing so, they’re not just helping to fight food insecurity—they’re also promoting independence and long-term solutions.

Social Activation

Increasing Visibility & Connection with Gen Z & Millennials Lead Content Creators



Keith Lee

Profile: Millennial – 16 Million on TikTok

Brand: Viral food critic focused on authenticity, quality, restoring and building community through food known as the "Keith Lee Effect"

Strategy: Curates content related to #GrowYourGarden meals created from personal garden



Yara Shahidi

Profile: Gen Z – 8.7M on Instagram

Brand: Actress, Social activist, Creator of The Optimist Project a visual and audio podcast that uplifts conversations with social game changers

Strategy: Promote WhyHunger and #GrowYourGarden initiatives through Yara's show with local food leaders in California on Instagram



Kai Cenat

Profile: Gen Z – 16.1 Million on Twitch

Brand: Online high energy streamer known for comedy, gaming, and giving back

Strategy: Kai X Twitch

Optimize Kai's largest platform by partnering with Twitch for a six-week streamathon watch along as he completes #GrowYourGarden challenges leading to the Hungerthon pop up

Partner Strategy

Partnerships
- Whole Foods Market
- Too Good to Go

Paid Social
- Paid Amplification
- Daily stories

Influencer
- 1 reel a week
- Drive to unique Hungerthon URL to track user engagement

Audio
- Streaming audio and podcast

Streaming
- Six-week Streamathon following #GrowYourGarden

DOOH
- High visibility and flexible messaging with rotating #WhyHunger banners and countdown

Display
- Cross device display banners

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Media Flighting

	Phase 1 Grow Together, Feed Together Nov 3rd-18th	Phase 2 Planting Seeds of Change Nov 19th- Dec 3rd	Phase 3 Rooted in Community Dec 4th-18th	Impressions Total 40.9 Million
Partnerships	$150,000			N/A
Paid Social	$50,000		$50,000	20,000,000
Influencer	$25,000	$25,000	$25,000	3,787,879
Audio		$50,000		2,777,778
Streaming	$60,000			4,000,000
DOOH	$30,000			1,666,667
Display			$35,000	8,750,000
Event			Hungerthon Pop Up	

Phase 1 KPI: Awareness

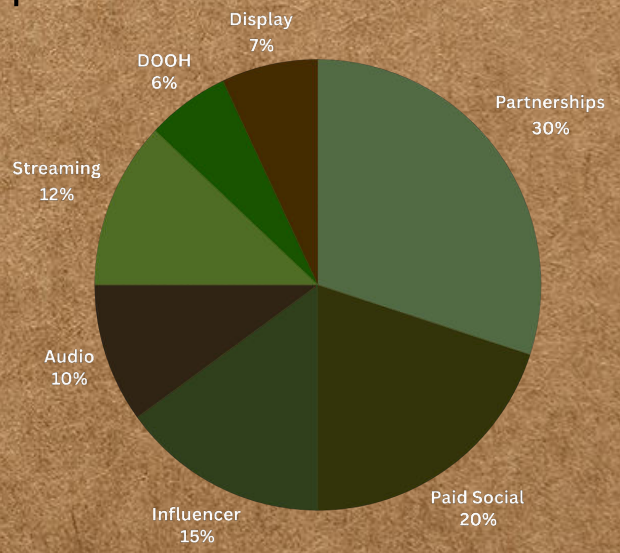
- KPIs: Engagement, CTR, Impressions
- Campaign Partner: Whole Foods Market
- Social: Likes, #GrowYourGarden usage, Shares, Donations
- Streaming: Twitch
- DOOH

Phase 2 KPI: Consideration

- KPIs: Engagement, CTR, Impressions, # of Posts related to Hashtag (Social Shares)
- Streaming Audio, Patreon + Sirus XM
- Campaign Partner: Whole Foods Market
- Influencer
- Streaming: Twitch
- DOOH

Phase 3 KPI: Longevity

- KPIs: Engagement, CTR, Impressions
- Streaming Audio: Patreon + Sirus XM
- Event Sponsor: Too Good To Go
- Campaign Partner: Whole Foods Market
- 3rd Party Display drives to WhyHunger digital tools



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Implementation

Participant Journey

HOW GREEN IS YOUR THUMB?



CHALLENGE 1:

Follow @WhyHunger on social media and interact with the posts

CHALLENGE 2:

Register for the eNewsletter on whyhunger.org

CHALLENGE 3:

Tag @WhyHunger on a photo of you in one of the gardening classes and use the #GrowYourGarden

CHALLENGE 4:

Upload an Instagram story and that shows you on the soup kitchen locator on the website and tag @WhyHunger

CHALLENGE 5:

Use the #GrowYourGarden and express which influencer you think is embracing WhyHunger's mission the best

CHALLENGE 6:

Pre-Order Hungerthon merch to support WhyHunger's milestone year

1

SOCIAL ACTIVATION

Kick-off influencer generated content that highlights the "Grow Your Garden" campagin and WhyHunger's mission and objectives.

2

SIGN UP

Click Link in @WhyHunger Instagram Bio or our Influencer's Platform handles to register and recieve unique Hungerthon login.

3

WHOLE FOODS X WHY HUNGER

Experience or watch local Whole Foods gardening classes to learn how to #GrowYourGarden while Growing your community.

4

YOUR IMPACT

Users can track and share their progress on their personal garden on socials using #GrowYourGarden and using Why Hunger's digital tools to locate local soup kitches and food drives in their city to donate produce.

5

DRIVING DONATIONS

Any form of monetary or food donations are welcome. Each influencer has pledged to donate 20% of money generated from 6 week Hungerthon challenge and curate content related to WhyHunger X Whole Foods and their learnings.

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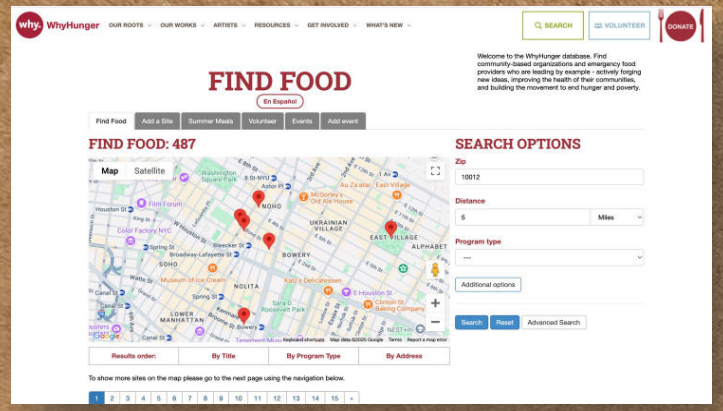
40TH HUNGERTHON & 5OTH WHY HUNGER ANNIVERSARY

The city with the most engagement and tracking is totaled. Participants will be invited to celebrate the Hungerthon initiative in their own city. Expriences with content creator team, grass root activities, and food insecuirty panals will be used to fuel future years of change and cultivate long term-relationships.

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Why It Works

A Sustainable Transformation for the next 50 Hungerthon's to Come



Before



2025 Hungerthon

01. Aligning with Audiences

- Addressing current WhyHunger audience while building experiential opportunities to cultivate relationships with new target audience
- Socially conscious Gen Z'ers
- Millennials aged 28-43

02. Revamped Messaging

- Refreshing messaging and visuals that evoke emotional alignment around WhyHunger's values, mission, and impact
- Forming long-lasting relationships and community beyond donations through amplified social and in-person communication.

03. Broaden Artists Touch

- Extending WhyHunger's artists driven mission by including main stream content creators in #GrowYourGarden campaign

04. Embracing long term impact

- Using relatable, transparent, and accessible brands corporate partners with parallel values
- Partners offer a lasting influencer and ongoing relevancy

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